MODULE 03

Vocal Warm-Ups

Build easy coordination and connect it to real music.



Hum to Open Vowel



Vowel Colour Circle

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

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28 *Gentle Repeated Notes*

29 *Echo Then Choose*

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Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 021

Hum to Open Vowel

Vocal Warm-Ups

4 minutes / Comfortable starting pitch, optional keyboard.

Move from a gentle hum into an open vowel without a sudden volume jump.



ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

1. *Hum 'mm' softly for two beats with the jaw easy; rest after each attempt.*
2. *On the same note, open from 'mm' to 'oo' while keeping the sound unforced.*
3. *Repeat on 'oh' and apply the smooth transition to one lyric syllable.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.

COMMON TRAP

Making the open vowel suddenly louder.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a gentle 'ng' only if it is familiar; otherwise stay with 'mm'.

ACTIVITY 022

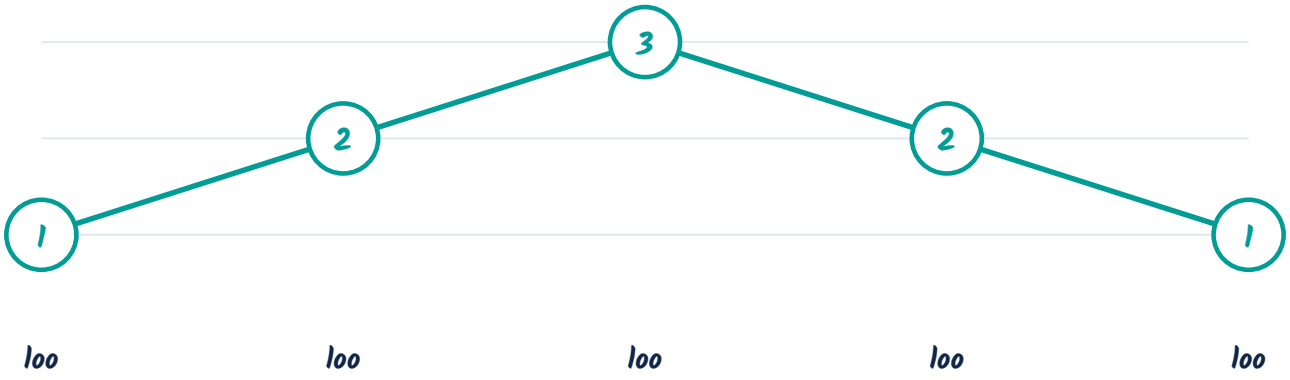
Three-Note Neighbourhood

Vocal Warm-Ups

4 minutes / A starting note matched to the group.

Coordinate a short stepwise pattern in a comfortable middle range.

Scale degrees in a comfortable key



One note per beat. Keep the same comfortable key until it feels easy.

1

Model scale degrees 1-2-3-2-1 on 'loo', one note per beat; let singers listen once.

2

Echo twice, resting between attempts; keep the same key until it is comfortable.

3

Move the starting note only a small amount if the entire group remains at ease.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

COMMON TRAP

Transposing before the pattern is comfortable.

MAKE IT WORK

Use 1-2-1 or allow singers to listen instead of transposing.

ACTIVITY 023

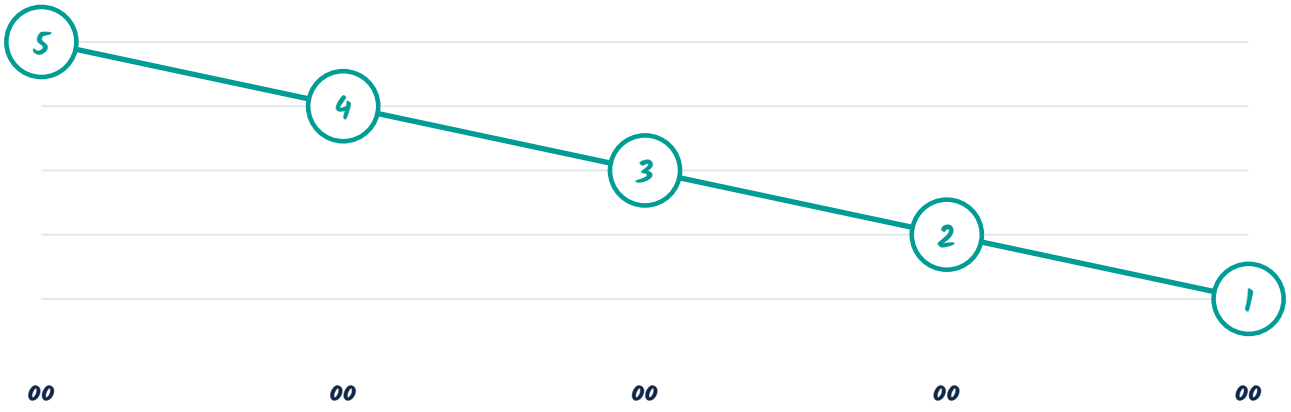
Gentle Descending Five

Vocal Warm-Ups

5 minutes / Optional keyboard for a suitable key.

Maintain an even vowel through a descending line.

Scale degrees in a comfortable key



A gentle descent. Keep the final notes clear instead of pushing them down.

1. *Model 5-4-3-2-1 on 'oo' in a range already comfortable for the choir.*
2. *Echo the pattern slowly, resting after each repetition and keeping the last note audible.*
3. *Repeat on 'oh', then use the same easy descent in a short repertoire passage.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The final notes stay clear without being pushed downward.

COMMON TRAP

Pushing the low end of the descent.

MAKE IT WORK

Reduce to 3-2-1 for changing or uncertain voices.

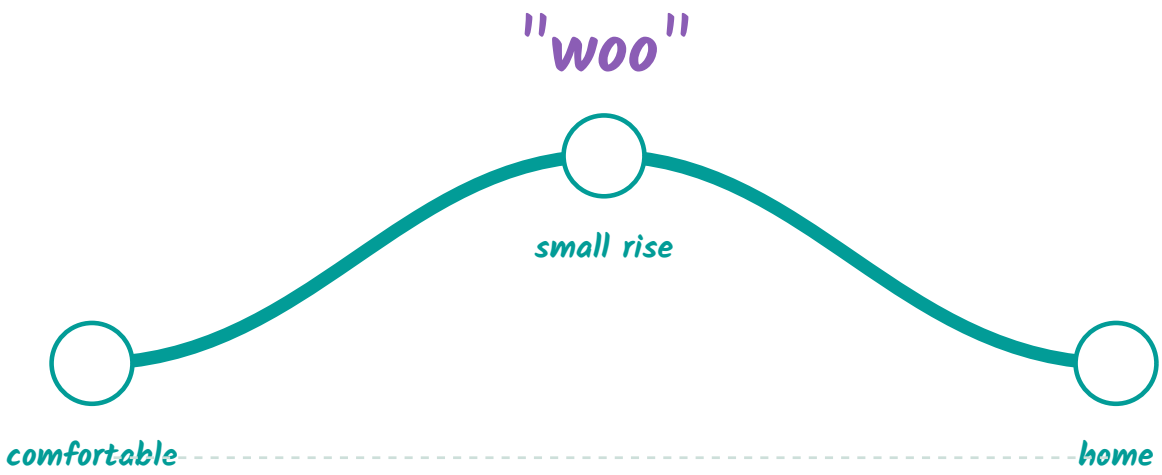
ACTIVITY 024

Small-Range Glide

Vocal Warm-Ups

3 minutes / No equipment.

Explore a connected sound within a modest, comfortable range.



A small, comfortable rise and return; this is not a range test.

1. Model a gentle 'woo' moving a small distance up and back down; avoid the extremes of your range.
2. Invite two brief echoes with an ordinary breath and rest between them.
3. Repeat once using a hand to trace the sound, then return to a single comfortable note.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The glide remains light and continuous rather than loud or stretched.

COMMON TRAP

Stretching the glide toward range extremes.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the exercise on one note if gliding encourages strain.

ACTIVITY 025

Vowel Colour Circle

Vocal Warm-Ups

5 minutes / A comfortable shared note.

Keep pitch steady while changing vowels.



oo — oh — ah

ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

The mouth shape changes while pitch and volume stay reasonably steady.

1. Sing 'oo-oh-ah' on one note, changing vowel on each beat and releasing on beat four.
2. Listen for pitch drifting when the mouth shape changes; repeat gently at the same volume.
3. Reverse the order, then use the most stable vowel in one phrase from the music.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Vowel changes are audible while pitch and volume stay reasonably consistent.

COMMON TRAP

Changing pitch every time the vowel changes.

MAKE IT WORK

Use just 'oo-oh' for two beats with younger groups.

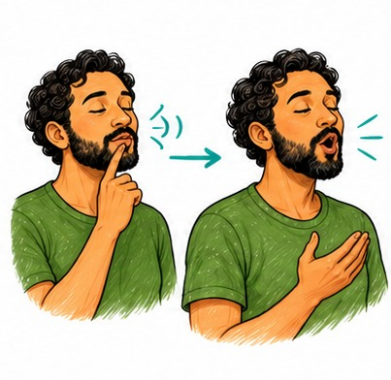
ACTIVITY 026

Soft 'V' Bridge

Vocal Warm-Ups

4 minutes / A comfortable speaking-range pitch.

Connect a voiced consonant to a clear vowel.



vvv → oo

continuous sound

Easy voiced start

Clear vowel

Keep the sound continuous across the change, then release and rest.

1. Model a gentle 'vvv-oo' for two beats, using little volume and no pressure at the lips.
2. Echo three times with rests, noticing the continuous sound between consonant and vowel.
3. Sing a short three-note descent using the same 'v' start.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The vowel begins smoothly rather than with an explosive onset.

COMMON TRAP

Pressing the lips to force a voiced v.

MAKE IT WORK

Use 'mm-oo' if a voiced 'v' is unfamiliar or uncomfortable.

ACTIVITY 027

Legato Beads

Vocal Warm-Ups

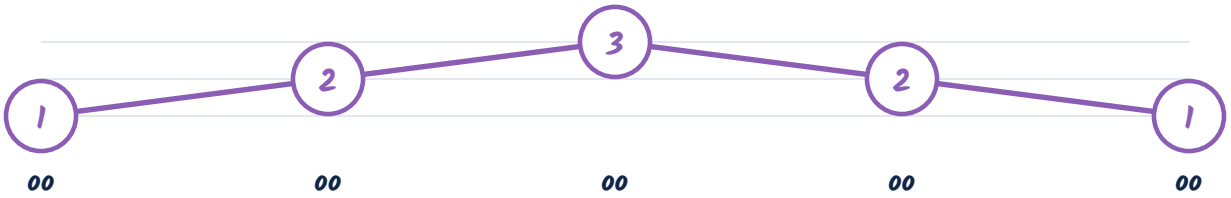
5 minutes / Pattern 1-2-3-2-1.

Join separate notes into one connected musical line.

SEPARATE SYLLABLES



ONE CONNECTED LINE



Same notes: compare separate "loo" syllables with one connected "oo".

1

Sing the pattern on separate 'loo' syllables to establish its notes.

2

Repeat on one continuous 'oo', imagining the notes as beads on the same thread.

3

Compare the two versions and transfer the connected version to a five-note phrase in repertoire.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The tone continues between notes without extra breaths or jaw pulses.

COMMON TRAP

Adding a jaw pulse or breath between every note.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the pattern to three notes and use a slower tempo.

ACTIVITY 028

Gentle Repeated Notes

Vocal Warm-Ups

4 minutes / A comfortable note and steady pulse.

Coordinate light repeated syllables without punching each onset.

Then rest before another attempt

FOUR EVEN BEATS

noo	noo	noo	noo
1	2	3	4
1	2	3	4

Four light beginnings, followed by four silent recovery beats.

1. Speak 'noo, noo, noo, noo' conversationally on four beats.
2. Sing the four syllables on one note with small, easy beginnings; rest for four beats.
3. Compare a clear version with an unnecessarily heavy version demonstrated only in speech, then choose the easier sung response.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Each syllable is clear without a hard attack or extra volume.

COMMON TRAP

Punching every repeated onset.

MAKE IT WORK

Sing two syllables per turn and listen for ease rather than speed.

ACTIVITY 029

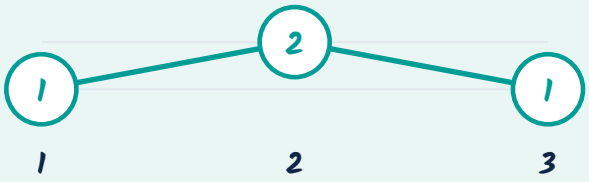
Echo Then Choose

Vocal Warm-Ups

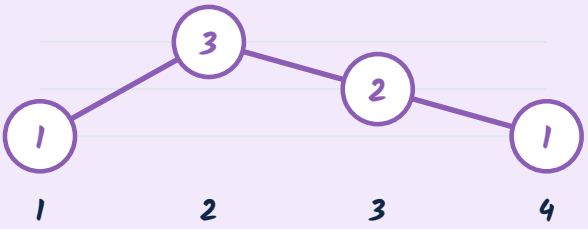
5 minutes / Two short patterns: 1-2-1 and 1-3-2-1.

Help singers select a comfortable warm-up option.

SHORTER



LONGER



Either choice can be useful

Listen to both. Choose an easy range, a different octave, or a listening turn.

1. *Model both patterns on 'mee' and have everyone listen before singing.*
2. *Let each singer choose the shorter or longer pattern while staying within their own comfortable range.*
3. *Alternate group responses, then ask which option prepared them best for today's music.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Choice improves participation without pressuring anyone to attempt an unsuitable range.

COMMON TRAP

Making the longer option a public achievement test.

MAKE IT WORK

Sing the chosen pattern in a different octave or listen if neither option feels easy.

ACTIVITY 030

Warm-Up to Song

Vocal Warm-Ups

6 minutes / A short phrase containing a three-note rise.

Connect a technical exercise to a real musical task.

1 / 2 / 3

Gentle "oo" pattern

VOWELS

Keep the actual rhythm

REAL WORDS

Restore concise consonants

A warm-up earns its place when it helps a real phrase.

1. Isolate the three-note rise and sing it gently on 'oo' at a comfortable pitch.
2. Add the actual vowels of the text, then its consonants without changing the musical shape.
3. Sing the full phrase and identify whether the exercise solved the original difficulty.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The full phrase improves in the specific way rehearsed, not just in general enthusiasm.

COMMON TRAP

Completing a warm-up without testing its transfer.

MAKE IT WORK

Slow the phrase or separate its rhythm from its pitches before combining them.